Home Leadership Kit

12 simple activities to build communication, leadership, curiosity and resilience in children aged 5 to 14

The idea in one line: marks get a child through school. The habits in this kit help them go further. They are built in small, relaxed moments at home, not in big programmes.

How to use this kit

1. **Pick one quality** to start with, the one your check-in suggested, or the one you most want to grow.
2. **Choose one activity** and do it for 10 to 15 minutes, 3 evenings a week, for 3 to 4 weeks.
3. **Keep it light.** If it starts to feel like homework, stop and try another. Enjoyment is the point.
4. **Praise effort and specifics** ("you explained that really clearly") rather than labels ("you are so smart").
5. **Use the tracker** on the last page to note what you notice.

The four qualities

Communication Saying what they think so others understand.	**Leadership** Starting things and owning outcomes.
Curiosity Asking why and how, learning beyond what is required.	**Resilience** Trying again after losing, failing or being disappointed.

1. Communication

A child who can explain, ask and persuade clearly will be heard, in class, in interviews and in life.

1. Three-part day

10 minutes, at dinner

How: Ask your child to tell their day in three parts: a beginning, a middle and an end. Then ask one curious follow-up question ("what happened next?").

Why it helps: Gives a simple structure for telling a story, which is the base of all clear speaking.

Ages: 5 to 8: use pictures or a drawing as prompts. 9 to 14: ask them to include one thing that surprised them.

2. Teach me

10 minutes, twice a week

How: Your child teaches you something they learned for 3 minutes, as if you were new to it. Ask two real questions. If you got confused, say where, kindly.

Why it helps: Explaining is the fastest way to learn and shows where the gaps are.

Ages: 9 to 11: school topics. 12 to 14: a skill or topic they chose, with a one-minute summary at the end.

3. Order it yourself

5 minutes, whenever you go out

How: Let your child place the order at a shop or restaurant, ask for directions or make a simple phone call, while you stand back and stay quiet.

Why it helps: Real conversations with unfamiliar people build speaking confidence faster than rehearsal at home.

Ages: 5 to 8: simple orders, you stay close. 9 to 14: a phone call to a relative or to book something.

2. Leadership and initiative

Leadership at this age is about taking responsibility and starting things, not about being in charge.

4. My job this week

2 minutes a day

How: Give your child one job that is only theirs for the week (watering plants, laying the table, planning the next day's bag). Check in once, then let them own it, including forgetting and fixing it.

Why it helps: Ownership builds reliability. Letting small lapses happen builds responsibility.

Ages: 5 to 8: simple daily job. 9 to 14: add planning and a weekly review with you.

5. Plan the outing

30 minutes to plan, a few hours to do

How: Let your child plan a family outing: where, how to get there, a small budget and a timeline. You follow the plan unless it is unsafe.

Why it helps: Planning with limits teaches decisions, trade-offs and how to handle a plan that goes wrong.

Ages: 9 to 11: a simple Sunday plan. 12 to 14: add a budget sheet and a back-up plan.

6. Captain of the week

Weekly

How: Rotate a family "captain" each week. The captain chooses one shared activity, makes sure everyone gets a turn to speak and summarises the plan at the end.

Why it helps: Leading is also about listening, including everyone and making sure the group finishes what it started.

Ages: 5 to 8: choose the game. 9 to 14: run a short family meeting with an agenda.

3. Curiosity

Curious children keep learning when nobody is testing them. That habit compounds for life.

7. Question jar

Daily to add, weekly to explore

How: Keep a jar. Any question your child asks that you cannot answer immediately goes in on a slip of paper. Pick one each weekend and find out together using two different sources.

Why it helps: Shows that not knowing is normal and that questions are valued.

Ages: 5 to 8: pictures and books. 9 to 14: compare two sources and discuss which you trust more.

8. How does it work?

20 minutes, weekly

How: Pick a safe everyday object (an old clock, a torch, a tap) and let your child take it apart or find out how it works, guessing before looking.

Why it helps: Guessing, testing and checking is the basic method of all learning.

Ages: 5 to 8: a toy or simple object with you nearby. 9 to 14: a video or manual, then explain it back.

9. Four-week experiment

15 minutes, 3 times a week for 4 weeks

How: Ask your child what they would like to get better at (drawing, a sport, coding, cooking). Agree a four-week experiment with a tiny goal, and note progress together each week.

Why it helps: Learning something unrelated to school makes the child the owner of their learning.

Ages: 9 to 11: pick one small skill. 12 to 14: they design the plan and measure the result.

4. Resilience

Resilience is not toughness. It is the ability to feel disappointed, then try again.

10. My story of trying again

10 minutes, occasionally

How: Tell your child about something you did not get right the first time and what you did next, including how you felt. Then ask whether they have felt similarly.

Why it helps: Normalises setbacks and shows a path through them.

Ages: 5 to 8: keep it short and simple. 9 to 14: include how long it took you to feel better.

11. Three questions after a letdown

5 minutes, after a disappointment

How: When something goes wrong (a bad result, a lost match), wait until they are calm. Then ask: What happened? What is in your control? What will you try next?

Why it helps: Moves a child from feeling stuck to planning a next step, without pretending it did not hurt.

Ages: 5 to 8: use one question, "what could we try next time?". 9 to 14: write the answers down.

12. Hard-thing notebook

5 minutes, 3 times a week

How: Choose one thing that is hard for your child. Each time they practise it, note one small improvement in a notebook. Review it each Sunday.

Why it helps: Showing progress over time proves that effort works, which is the root of persistence.

Ages: 5 to 8: stickers on a chart. 9 to 14: a notebook with dates and a short note.

Four-week tracker

Print this page or copy it into a notebook. Note small things. Over a month, patterns become visible.

Week	Quality and activity	What I noticed	What to try next
1			
2			
3			
4			

A few reminders

• Every child grows at their own pace. Compare your child with their own past, not with other children.

• If you have concerns about your child's development, anxiety, mood or behaviour, please speak to a qualified professional such as your paediatrician or a child psychologist. This kit is not a substitute.

• Home is where it starts. A relaxed home where mistakes are safe matters more than any single activity.

Help us learn from you. We are an early-stage team building with parents. If you are willing to share what worked, what did not and what you wish existed, please message us on WhatsApp or reply to the message that brought you this kit. A 15-minute conversation helps us more than you might expect.